12.4.3.1.3 Buttons and Button Holes :

Buttons are both functional as well as decorative. They should be selected with care to suit the colour, design and texture of the fabric and style of the garment. Decorative buttons vary in the form of glass, metal and plastic. Buttons have two or four holes. Mark the area where the button has to be sewn. Place the button and make a crosswise or vertical stitch connecting the four holes in the buttons. If the button is with a single hole in the wrong side of the button, place this on the right side of the garment, insert the needle from back side, through the garment and then pass the thread into the hole in the back side of the button and then pick the needle back into the garment. This is repeated 3 to 4 times to fix the button. Buttonholes are slits cut in the garment to hold the buttons in place. It can be made vertically or horizontally with the button sitting exactly at the centre of the front line. The raw edges of the slit are finished with buttonhole stitch (Figure 12.31).

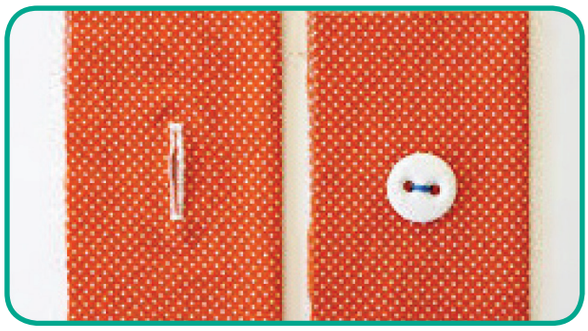


Figure 12.31 Button Hole and Button

12.4.3.1.4 Zippers

Zippers come in a wide variety of colours, length and types. All zippers consists either a chain of metal or plastic teeth or a synthetic coil joined to a fabric tape made of cotton or cotton polyester blend.

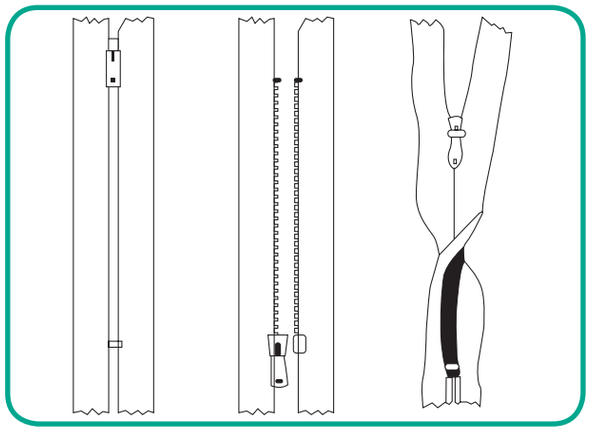


Figure 12.32 Conventional, Separating and Invisible Zipper

It has stoppers at the top or bottom which keep the sliders from running off the zipper. There are three basic types of zippers available in the market. They are (Figure 12.32).

(i) **Conventional Zipper:** These are zippers with exposed teeth or chain and open at the top but are held together at the bottom.

(ii) **Separating Zipper:** They are open at both the top and the bottom and permit the zipper opening to separate completely as in jackets with opened fronts.

(iii) **Invisible Zipper:** They are the newest zippers and as the name implies they are not visible in the front as they disappear into the seam. They are mostly used in skirts and in dresses.

Other types of zippers include two way zipper, trouser zipper and decorative zipper.

12.4.3.1.5 Elastics

Elastics are used in areas where stretching is desired. There are different types of elastics available in the market and should be selected carefully according to the end

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